LANGUAGE ACCESS HUB · POWERED BY TAIKA TRANSLATIONS

Title I Allowable Uses Checklist

Language access & accessibility services — ESSA Section 1116 · Title I, Part A

NOT LEGAL ADVICE

This checklist is a practical guide to allowable uses of Title I, Part A funds for language access and accessibility services. It is not legal advice. Final determinations of allowability rest with the LEA's comprehensive needs assessment and schoolwide or targeted assistance plan, and are subject to state educational agency monitoring. Services must be necessary, reasonable, and allocable under 2 CFR Part 200, Subpart E. Core EL language instruction and civil-rights obligations under Title VI and, where applicable, the EEOA are generally not chargeable to Title I or Title III if the district must provide them regardless of federal funding.

Start here: can we charge this to Title I?

- ☐ The activity is tied to a need identified in our comprehensive needs assessment or schoolwide plan.
- ☐ It is supplemental — not a service we already provide to all families with non-Federal funds.
- ☐ It is not core EL instruction or a civil-rights obligation we must provide regardless of funding (Title VI / EEOA).
- ☐ It takes place at, or supports, a Title I school or a Title I-required activity.
- ☐ We can document the trace-back and show invoices mapped to federal object codes.

Title I vs. Title III — the distinction that protects your budget

Title I, Part A — best for supplemental parent & family engagement, Title I-specific notices, meetings, compacts, and supports tied to a need in the schoolwide plan.

Title III, Part A — narrow: Title III-required notices only (EL identification/placement, English-proficiency progress). Not for general communications sent to every family, staff whose duties serve all students, or state-assessment translation.

Civil-rights floor: Title VI meaningful-access obligations apply regardless of which Title pays. Services you must provide to everyone are not "supplemental" and should not be charged to either Title.

The 1% Parent & Family Engagement set-aside (Section 1116(a)(3))

- ☐ **LEA allocation over $500,000? At least 1% is reserved for parent & family engagement — at least 90% to schools, up to 10% retained at the district.**
- ☐ Translation & interpretation of Title I meetings, notices, and school-parent compacts is a direct, well-supported use of this set-aside.
- ☐ At or below $500,000: no mandatory set-aside, but Section 1116 still applies — the same needs exist, just without a dedicated minimum line.

Five allowable scenarios — with copy-and-adapt justification language

1. **Interpretation at Title I parent meetings, the Annual Title I Meeting, and schoolwide plan input sessions.**
   "Interpretation services ensure meaningful participation by LEP parents in Title I parent and family engagement activities required under ESSA Section 1116."
2. **Translation of PFE policies, school-parent compacts, and Title I-related notices.**
   "Translated materials provide information in a format and language parents can understand, as required under ESSA Section 1116(f), for a need identified in the comprehensive needs assessment."
3. **Supplemental accessible instructional materials / digital accessibility supports (identified in the schoolwide plan).**
   "Accessible materials address a gap identified in the comprehensive needs assessment and supplement, rather than replace, services already required under IDEA and Section 504."
4. **Professional development for staff serving Title I students on supporting ELs / accessible instruction.**
   "Professional development builds staff capacity to serve Title I students identified in the schoolwide plan as needing additional language or accessibility support."
5. **Family literacy or engagement activities that remove language barriers.**
   "This activity is a supplemental Title I parent and family engagement activity addressing the language access barrier identified in the needs assessment."

Request a Title I-ready quote — budget-justification language and audit documentation built in.

teamtaika.com/title-i-language-access-accessibility

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